

ARISE

Adolescent Reproductive Health Information Support & Empowerment

MENTAL HEALTH & DRUGS

Stress & Mental Health

Student Study Guide & Quiz Answer Key

Module:	Mental Health & Drugs
Lesson:	Stress & Mental Health
Quiz:	25 marks (10 MCQ + 5 Fill-in-blanks + 3 Short Answer)
Pass Mark:	15/25 (60%) — Certificate awarded at 60%+
Languages:	English Kiswahili Sheng

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Define mental health using the WHO model and explain the mental health continuum
2. Explain the biology of stress — including cortisol, the fight-or-flight response, and chronic damage
3. Identify signs of depression, anxiety disorder, PTSD, and eating disorders
4. Compare healthy and unhealthy coping strategies and build a personal mental health toolkit
5. Recognise crisis warning signs and correctly apply Kenya's support resources

Slide 2: What Is Mental Health? — The Full Picture

Mental health is NOT just the absence of illness. It is a state of active wellbeing — and it exists on a continuum. It can change every day.

KEY TERM: WHO Definition — Mental Health

A state of wellbeing in which an individual realises their own abilities, can cope with the normal stresses of life, can work productively and fruitfully, and is able to make a contribution to their community.

Mental Health State	What It Feels Like	What Helps
Thriving ■	Energised, engaged, resilient, purposeful	Maintain healthy habits, nurture relationships
Coping / Surviving	Stressed but managing, mood variable	Extra rest, talk to someone, reduce load
Struggling ■	Overwhelmed, withdrawing, loss of joy	Seek counsellor support urgently
In Crisis ■	Unable to function, self-harm thoughts	Emergency help NOW — Befrienders 0722 178 177

Slide 3: The Science of Stress — What Happens Inside

Stress is not just in your head — it triggers a full-body biological response. Understanding this helps you manage it.

KEY TERM: The Stress Response

When the brain perceives a threat, it releases adrenaline and cortisol (stress hormones). Heart rate increases, muscles tense, breathing quickens — the body prepares to fight or flee. Short-term: adaptive and useful. Chronic (long-term): damaging.

Body System	Short-Term Stress	Chronic Stress Damage
Brain / Mind	Heightened alertness, faster reactions	Anxiety, depression, memory loss, inability to concentrate
Heart & Circulation	Increased heart rate — pumping more blood to muscles	Sustained high blood pressure, increased heart attack and stroke risk

Body System	Short-Term Stress	Chronic Stress Damage
Immune System	Temporarily boosted for immediate threat	Suppressed — more infections, slower healing, autoimmune issues
Digestive System	Slowed — energy diverted to muscles	Stomach ulcers, IBS, nausea, appetite loss
Sleep	Temporary alert state — some sleep loss OK	Chronic insomnia — which then TRIPLES stress levels (vicious cycle)

■ ■ ■ Cortisol Warning

■ Cortisol (the stress hormone) is helpful in short bursts but destructive when chronically elevated. It literally shrinks the hippocampus (memory centre of the brain), impairs immune function, disrupts sleep, and triggers depression. Managing stress is not optional — it is biological necessity.

Slide 4: Mental Health Conditions — Know the Signs

Knowing the name and signs of a mental health condition removes fear and enables early help. These are medical conditions — not character flaws.

Condition	Key Symptoms	Common Trigger in Kenya	Treatment
Depression	Persistent sadness, loss of interest, fatigue, sleep/appetite changes, worthlessness, hopelessness (2+ weeks)	Exam failure, bereavement, family breakdown, poverty stress	Counselling + medication if needed
Anxiety Disorder	Excessive persistent worry, racing heart, sweating, avoidance, panic attacks, difficulty breathing	Exams, peer pressure, family violence, social media comparison	Cognitive Behavioural Therapy (CBT), breathing techniques, medication

Condition	Key Symptoms	Common Trigger in Kenya	Treatment
PTSD	Flashbacks, nightmares, emotional numbness, hypervigilance, avoidance of reminders, anger outbursts	GBV/abuse, accidents, witnessing violence, displacement, loss	Trauma-focused CBT, EMDR therapy, support groups
Eating Disorders	Extreme food restriction OR binge-purge cycles, distorted body image, obsession with weight	Social media body image pressure, diet culture, stress, control needs	Specialist eating disorder team, nutritional support, therapy

Baraka, 16, started failing exams after his parents separated. He stopped eating regularly, couldn't sleep, lost interest in football he loved, and felt 'like a burden to everyone.' His teacher noticed and referred him to the school counsellor. After 8 sessions of CBT, Baraka understood he had depression — a medical condition. 'I thought I was just weak,' he says. 'Knowing it had a name and a treatment changed everything.'

Slide 5: Coping Strategies — What Works vs What Destroys

How you respond to stress either builds resilience or digs you deeper. The choice — often made in seconds — can shape months of your life.

Unhealthy Coping	Why It Feels Good Temporarily	Why It Makes Things Worse	Healthy Swap
Drugs / alcohol	Temporarily numbs emotions	Addiction, brain damage, worsens depression and anxiety long-term	Exercise, breathing, talking
Social media bingeing	Distraction, temporary connection feeling	Comparison, FOMO, blue light disrupts sleep, deepens isolation	1–2 hr limit, unfollow negativity, call a friend instead
Avoiding the problem	Short-term relief from discomfort	Problems grow larger, anxiety around them grows, self-confidence shrinks	Break it into small steps, tackle one piece daily

Unhealthy Coping	Why It Feels Good Temporarily	Why It Makes Things Worse	Healthy Swap
Sleeping all day / isolation	Escape from overwhelming feelings	Worsens depression, disrupts sleep cycle, deepens withdrawal	Gentle routine, 1 social interaction daily, short walk
Self-harm	Temporary relief from emotional pain (not attention-seeking)	Physical danger, shame cycle, escalation, does not resolve emotional pain	Tell a trusted adult now — counsellor, Befrienders 0722 178 177

■ ■ Your 5-Step Mental Health Toolkit

Slide 6: Module Video

Watch carefully, then continue to the scenarios.

Slide 7: Real Talk — What Would You Do?

Pick your choice and see the consequence.

Slide 8: Recognising Crisis & Getting Help in Kenya

Knowing when normal struggle becomes a crisis — and knowing exactly what to do — can be the difference between life and death.

Resource	Contact	What They Provide	Cost
Befrienders Kenya	0722 178 177	24/7 emotional support, suicide prevention, confidential	FREE
School Counsellor	At your school	Mental health support, referrals, safe space to talk	FREE
Childline Kenya	116	24/7 support for children under 18, crisis intervention	FREE
Mathare Hospital Nairobi	020 2723 031	Inpatient and outpatient psychiatric services, therapy	Free with referral

Resource	Contact	What They Provide	Cost
County Mental Health Clinics	Your nearest county hospital	Mental health assessment, medication, therapy	NHIF / low cost
Emergency Services	999 / 112	If someone is in immediate danger of harming themselves or others	FREE

■ ■ ■ Crisis Warning Signs — Act Immediately

■ Any of these in yourself or a friend: ① Expressing thoughts of suicide or self-harm ② Giving away valued possessions ('just in case') ③ Saying unusual goodbyes ④ Extreme sudden withdrawal from everyone ⑤ Sudden calmness after deep depression (may have decided on a plan) ⑥ Reckless, dangerous behaviour ⑦ Prolonged inability to function — cannot eat, sleep, or attend school for weeks.

Quiz — Answer Key

Total: 25 marks | Pass: 15/25 (60%) | Certificate at 60%+

Part A: Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. 1. According to the WHO, mental health is BEST defined as:

- ☐ A. The complete absence of any sadness or worry
- ☒ B. A state of wellbeing where a person realises their abilities, copes with normal stress, works productively, and contributes to their community
- ☐ C. Only the absence of diagnosed mental illness
- ☐ D. Feeling happy and calm at all times

2. 2. The MAIN difference between normal stress and a stress disorder is:

- ☐ A. Normal stress has no physical effects
- ☒ B. Normal stress is temporary and proportionate to the challenge; a disorder is persistent, overwhelming, and significantly impairs daily life
- ☐ C. Only adults experience stress disorders
- ☐ D. Stress disorders cannot be treated

3. 3. Clinical depression is characterised by:

- ☐ A. Feeling sad for a day or two after bad news
- ☒ B. Persistent low mood, loss of interest in previously enjoyable activities, fatigue, sleep or appetite changes, and feelings of worthlessness lasting 2+ weeks
- ☐ C. Only affecting people who have had trauma
- ☐ D. Feeling unmotivated for a single week

4. 4. Anxiety disorder differs from normal worry because it is:

- ☐ A. Felt only before exams
- ☒ B. Persistent, excessive, and disproportionate to any real threat — accompanied by physical symptoms like racing heart, sweating, and avoidance that disrupt daily life
- ☐ C. Only experienced by girls
- ☐ D. Always visible to people around you

5. 5. Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD) can develop after:

- ☐ A. Failing a single exam
- ☒ B. Exposure to a traumatic event such as violence, abuse, accident, or serious loss — causing flashbacks, nightmares, and hypervigilance
- ☐ C. Watching too much television
- ☐ D. Sleeping fewer than 6 hours one night

6. 6. Exercise reduces stress and improves mood primarily because it:

- ☐ A. Tires you out so you forget your problems
- ☒ B. Releases endorphins (natural mood elevators), reduces cortisol (stress hormone), improves sleep quality, and builds self-efficacy
- ☐ C. Only helps physical fitness, not mental health
- ☐ D. Makes you too tired to feel anxious

7. 7. Which is a WARNING SIGN of a mental health crisis in a young person?

- ☐ A. Getting excited about a school trip

☒ B. Giving away valued possessions, expressing hopelessness, extreme withdrawal, expressing thoughts of self-harm or suicide

☐ C. Wanting to sleep 8–9 hours a night

☐ D. Feeling nervous before a presentation

8. 8. Mental health stigma is harmful because it:

☐ A. Encourages people to seek help faster

☒ B. Prevents people from seeking treatment, causes shame and isolation, and leads to preventable suffering and deaths from untreated conditions

☐ C. Only affects adults over 40

☐ D. Makes mental health conditions less serious

9. 9. When a friend expresses suicidal thoughts, the MOST important immediate action is:

☐ A. Tell them to think positively and cheer up

☒ B. Listen without judgment, stay with them, take it seriously, and immediately connect them to a trusted adult or call Befrienders Kenya: 0722 178 177

☐ C. Change the subject to distract them

☐ D. Leave them to figure it out alone

10. 10. The Kenyan crisis support line available free 24/7 for emotional distress and suicide prevention is:

☐ A. NACADA: 0800 723 253

☒ B. Befrienders Kenya: 0722 178 177

☐ C. Childline: 116

☐ D. Kenya Red Cross: 1199

Part C: Short Answer (25 marks)

1. 1. The WHO defines _____ health as a state of wellbeing where you realise your abilities, cope with stress, work productively, and contribute to your community. (3 marks)

2. 2. Persistent low mood, loss of interest, and fatigue lasting more than two weeks is a sign of clinical _____. (3 marks)

3. 3. The brain chemical released during exercise that naturally improves mood is called _____. (3 marks)

4. 4. The free 24/7 Kenyan crisis and suicide prevention helpline run by Befrienders Kenya is: 0722 178 _____. (3 marks)

5. 5. Negative attitudes and shame that prevent people from seeking mental health help is called _____. (3 marks)

6. Explain the difference between normal stress and clinical depression, and list FOUR symptoms of depression. (3 marks marks) (3 marks)

7. Describe FIVE evidence-based healthy coping strategies for managing adolescent stress. For each, explain WHY it works. (4 marks marks) (5 marks)

8. Your close friend has been very withdrawn for three weeks, gave away their favourite items, and said 'nobody would miss me if I was gone.' What do you do — step by step? (2 marks marks) (2 marks)